

CHAPTER ONE
SHOWDOWN IN LAGOS

The Avengers have changed since we last saw them. They've lost comrades-in-arms and gained new allies—and with a new team comes a new direction. At the onset of the film, we find Captain America leading a reconnaissance mission in Lagos, the largest city in Nigeria. "The opening set piece reintroduces audiences to the characters of Steve Rogers, Sam Wilson, and Natasha Romanoff as a trio," Executive Producer Nate Moore says. "We kind of see them as the cornerstone of the Captain America franchise. At the same time, it folds in a new character: Wanda Maximoff, the Scarlet Witch. To see that dynamic—this sort of new team forming as they're trying to hunt down Crossbones in Nigeria in a completely new setting—is really special."

Production Designer Owen Paterson and Directors Joe and Anthony Russo approached the world of Marvel's *Captain America: Civil War* with a grounded, real-world eye. "Joe and Anthony, I think they're both really good storytellers. They wanted to achieve a realistic nature to the film. They didn't want it to be overly stylized," Paterson explains. "They wanted it to feel like we were in real places, hence why we chose the locations we did. Though it's a great-looking, visually dynamic space, it's also very real, and it's connected to outside spaces. They didn't want it overly flashy. They wanted to tell their story, and keep the focus about the characters and their exchanges." That storytelling drive is at the center of the collaborative process for conceptualizing, altering, and creating these environments and characters—and as with previous installments in the Marvel Cinematic Universe, it begins with the artists.